A-A-53674
6 September 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SHEARS, RIB CUTTING (Stille)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers a Stille rib cutting shears suitable for use in thoracic surgery.

Salient characteristics:

General. The shears shall have a crescent-shaped jaw and an overall length of 10 inches. The handle shall have a thumb projection and incorporate either a single of double spring.

Material. The material of the shears shall be Class 4 corrosion-resistant steel in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Designation F899.

Hardness. The shears blade shall have a Rockwell Hardness C scale (HRC) of 50, minimum. The crescent-shaped jaw shall have a Rockwell Hardness C Scale (HRC) of 45 to 50. The hardness shall be tested in accordance with ASTM Designation E18 or ASTM Designations E92 and E140.

Style, design and dimensions. The shears shall be in accordance with Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing No. 22321 for style, design and dimensions.

Finish. The finish of the shears shall be mirror, satin, or matte. The matte finish shall exhibit a uniform nondirectional surface texture equivalent to that produced by lightly blasting the prepared surface with fine abrasives under pressure.

Passivation. The shears shall be properly passivated.

Corrosion resistance. The shears shall show no signs of corrosion when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation F1089.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

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Performance. The shears shall operate smoothly and freely without binding. When closed, the action of the blade against the crescent shaped jaw shall be smooth and form a precise cutting edge. The mechanism shall be sufficiently tight to ensure correct alignment so there is no free-play. The shears shall be capable of cutting through a 0.042 inch piece of paper cleanly.

Identification marking. The shears shall bear the contractor's name, or registered trademark and the word "stainless". Shears of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of origin.

Product Quality Level

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests assuring that materials are in accordance with requirements.

Unit. Each (EA). One rib cutting shears, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with and AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an Inspection level of II. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one shears. Defects shall be those listed below.

Defects

Shears not free from cracks, pits, burs, sharp edges, scale, rough areas or corrosion.

Finish of the shears not as specified.

Style, design and dimensions not as specified.

Paper cutting test. Use a piece of writing paper 0.003 inch thick to make the cut. White tablet paper is an example. Paper should not fold. The shears which cannot cut are rejected.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one shears. The AQL shall be 1.0 (percent defective) with and Inspection level of S-2.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

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NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-139-8238	SHEARS, RIB CUTTING, Stille, 10 Inch

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 52426

Project No. 6515-4290

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53674	SHEARS, RIB CUTTING (Stille)

3a NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a Paragraph Number and Wording

b Recommended Wording

c Reason Rationale to Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last First MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

(TO DETACH THIS FORM CUT ALONG THIS LINE.)

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NOTE. This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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